

Alper Şükrü Gençer

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Education

New York University, New York, NY

2021-Present: Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science (expected May 2027)

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.89/4.00.
- Dissertation Committee: Prof. Cyrus Samii (Chair), Prof. Gwyneth McClendon, Prof. Michael Gilligan, Prof. Sevgi Yüksel

Washington University in St. Louis, Saint Louis, MO

2019-2021: M.A., Political Science,

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods, Formal Theory.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

2017 - 2019: M.A., Political Science and International Relations,

- Magna Cum Laude: Top 5% of the Graduate School,
- Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00.

Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

2013 - 2017: B.A., Economics,

2011 - 2017: B.A., Political Science,

- Magna Cum Laude: Top 1% of Economics & Political Science,
- Minor in History
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

Bocconi University, Milan, ITALY

2014 - 2015: Erasmus Study Abroad Program in Economics.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Yörük, E. & Gençer, A.Ş. (2022, September). “The dynamics of welfare state regime development in the Global South: Structures, institutions, and political agency.” *Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis*. doi: [10.1080/13876988.2021.2004541](https://doi.org/10.1080/13876988.2021.2004541).

Yörük, E. & Gençer, A.Ş. (2020, August). “The politics of social assistance in South Africa: How protests and electoral politics shape the Child Support Grant.” *Governance*. doi: [10.1111/gove.12464](https://doi.org/10.1111/gove.12464).

Öniş, Z. & Gençer, A.Ş. (2018, February). “Democratic BRICS as role models in a shifting global order: Inherent dilemmas and the challenges ahead.” *Third World Quarterly*, 39(3). doi: [10.1080/01436597.2018.1438185](https://doi.org/10.1080/01436597.2018.1438185).

Papers Under Review

Gençer, A.Ş. “Rethinking ‘Them’: Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies.” Under review.

Gençer, A.Ş. “When Do Electoral Power Grabs Increase Support for Election Monitoring? Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Turkey.” Under review.

Working Papers and Ongoing Projects

Gençer, A.Ş. “Unbundling Autocratic Capture: Complexity, Selective Emphasis, and Democratic Accountability.” Job Market Paper.

Gençer, A.Ş. & Samii, C. “Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives.”

Gençer, A.Ş. “Mapping Stereotype-Prone Issues in Polarized Democracies.”

Gençer, A.Ş. “What Does Disaster Risk Buy? Political Allocation and the Composition of Mitigation Investment.”

Gençer, A.Ş. “Constrained Accountability after Disaster: Evidence from Turkey’s 2023 Earthquakes.”

Gençer, A.Ş. & Civitarese, C. “Monitoring, Cognitive Load, and Strategic Omission in Political Communication.”

Gençer, A.Ş., Tafoya, G.R., Yörük, E., & Yoltar, C. “Carrots and Sticks: Social Assistance as a Containment Strategy in Brazil.”

Conference Presentations

2026: Behavioral Models of Politics
“Unbundling Autocratic Capture”

2026: NYU Rebecca Morton Experimental Conference
“Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives”

2025: NYU Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics
“Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives”

2025: Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference
“Rethinking ‘Them’: Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies”

2024: NYU Rebecca Morton Experimental Conference
“Rethinking ‘Them’: Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies”

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

2025 - 2026: APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant, Washington, DC

- American Political Science Association; \$13,343 for “Unbundling Autocratic Capture”

2025 - 2026: Identities & Ideologies Project (NYU) Research Grant, New York, NY

- \$3,000 for “Measuring Stereotype-Prone Beliefs: Validation of a Representativeness-Based Algorithm”

2022, 2023, 2025: New York University George Downs Prize, New York, NY

- Competitive departmental award supporting dissertation research in political science \$1,500 (2022), \$2,500 (2023), \$2,000 (2025)

2021 - Present: New York University Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship, New York, NY

- Full tuition and living stipend

2019 - 2021: Washington University in St. Louis Graduate School Scholarship, Saint Louis, MO

- Full tuition and living stipend

2017 - 2019: TÜBİTAK Graduate Scholarship, Ankara, TURKEY

- 2210A National Scholarship Program for M.Sc. Students

2017 - 2019: Koç University High Success Scholarship for Graduate Studies, Istanbul, TURKEY

- Full tuition, housing, and stipend

2017: Koç University Magna Cum Laude Award, Istanbul, TURKEY

- Second-highest academic record among Political Science and International Relations graduates

2014 - 2015: Erasmus Exchange Scholarship, Bocconi University, ITALY

- Merit-based scholarship covering one semester stipend

2013 - 2016: Turkish Education Foundation (TEV) Outstanding Success Scholarship, Istanbul, TURKEY

- Highly competitive national scholarship awarded to 50 students annually

2011 - 2017: Koç University High Honor Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies, Istanbul, TURKEY

- Full tuition, housing, and living stipend; awarded to students ranking in the top 1,000 on the national university entrance examination

Teaching

New York University, New York, NY

Recitation Leader

- International Politics: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2026
- Introduction to Comparative Politics: Fall 2024
- Introduction to Research Methods: Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

- Quantitative Methods: Fall 2025

Quantitative Methods Advisor, Democracy Research Initiative

- Fall 2025, Spring 2026

Washington University in St. Louis, Saint Louis, MO

Teaching Assistant

- International Politics: Fall 2020
- Quantitative Methods: Spring 2021

Research Experience

September 2023 - May 2025: New York University, New York, NY

Research Assistant, xmachine

- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Cyrus Samii and Prof. Michael Gechter
- Collected, cleaned, and managed data from multiple countries and reproduced results from field experiments
- Applied machine-learning methods for out-of-sample prediction and conducted structural estimation
- Developed statistical visualizations and maintained reproducible research workflows in R and Git

September 2017 - August 2022: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Researcher, Emerging Welfare Project

- Full-time Researcher and Team Member, September 2017 - August 2019
- Part-time Researcher, September 2019 - August 2022
- Worked on the European Research Council project “Emerging Welfare” under the supervision of Prof. Erdem Yörük
- Conducted quantitative analysis and fieldwork on politics of social assistance, including interviews with state officials, academics, and NGOs
- Coordinated data collection on welfare, social policy, and political and economic indicators
- Contributed to manuscripts on the political determinants of social assistance expansion

February 2018 - January 2019: Institute of Istanbul Political Research (IstanPol), Istanbul, TURKEY

Volunteer Researcher

- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality in Turkey
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of Syrian child refugees in Turkey

September 2016 - June 2017: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Research Assistant (RA)

- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Ziya Öniş
- Conducted literature reviews on the political economy of development and democracy in the Global South
- Published an article on the role model capabilities of the democratic BRICS for the Global South

September 2016 - December 2017: Political and Social Research Institute of Europe (PS Europe), Istanbul, TURKEY

Volunteer Researcher

- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of asylum seekers, migrants, and refugees in Turkey
- Participated in “Armenia Turkey Dialogue Project,” which aimed at establishing a dialogue between Turkish and Armenian academics and civil society activists

Published Reports

Gençer, A.Ş. et al. (2018, October). “From information to perception: The journey of the Syrian “ghost” children in Istanbul.” *IstanPol*. **Access:** [Link](#).

Gençer, A.Ş. et al. (2017, July). “A study on the perception of asylum-seekers, migrants, and refugees in Turkey.” *PS Europe*. **Access:** [Link](#).

Published Dataset

Yörük, E., Tafoya, G.R., Öker, İ., Bargu, A., **Gençer, A.Ş.**, Çemen, R., Kına, F., Yoltar, Ç., Gürel, B., & Koyuncu, M. (2019). “Global Welfare Dataset, Version 2019.” *EMW Project*. **Access:** [Link](#)

Research Interests

Democratic Backsliding, Political Accountability, Political Behavior; Information Processing, Affective Polarization, Authoritarian Politics; Survey and Field Experiments, Causal Inference, Experimental Design

Languages and Skills

Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (Intermediate), Arabic (Intermediate)  (advanced), L^AT_EX (advanced),  (intermediate), Stata (intermediate), [GitHub](#)

References

Prof. Gwyneth McClendon

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Dissertation Advisor

Prof. Cyrus Samii

Dept. of Politics
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Dissertation Chair

Prof. Michael Gilligan

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Dissertation Advisor